

FLOOD AID CRITICIZED

The 27 August 1965 issue of Bratislava Pravda carries the Ministry of Construction's rebuttal to criticism that it is mismanaging the publicly subscribed flood disaster aid. Criticism is being levied by the Slovak Danube River flood victims who are becoming disenchanted with daily press and radio broadcast accounts of accumulated donations and who have yet to see tangible proof in the form of bricks, cement, and various prefabricates.

S. Malik, secretary of the flood commission and the man who keeps the Ministry of Construction informed on disbursements, gave the following explanation: According to plans the flood victims will receive, among other things, a total of 10 million bricks by the end of August and an additional 10 million by the end of September. Between 17 July and 22 August a number of brick kilns have contributed the allotted quota. These were delivered to certain disaster areas in overabundance whereas other areas received none. Responsibility for delivery and distribution does not lie with the Ministry of Construction but with the railroad and business concerns. It has been shown that sufficient amounts of cement have been delivered to the flood areas but because of unsatisfactory storage the cement is hardening. By 19 August the Ministry of Construction issued 870,000 slate shingles, 108,000 pieces of asbestos cement roofing, 34,000 meters of square tiles, 5,933 meters of prefabricates. The Ministry of Construction has been conscientiously fulfilling its tasks. However, it is sending these items where it is told to send by the organs that control the rehabilitation of the devastated areas. (EEDPR, 7 Sep 65)

* FLYING SAUCER REPORT

[Note: For several weeks, the Hungarian language daily Uj Szo, published in Bratislava, has given extensive, frequently front page, coverage to flying saucer reports, usually from South America but sometimes from other areas, attributing them to the French news service AFP, Reuters, etc. Occasionally, these articles included explanations by Czechoslovak experts who discounted the stories and offered alternatives to the extraterrestrial hypotheses. The 20 August 1965 issue of Uj Szo published a front page CTK (Czechoslovak Press Office) dispatch from San Salvador reporting a photograph of a flying saucer published in Prensa Grafica, Salvador. The following is a full translation of a page 2 CTK story in the same issue of Uj Szo.]

(cont'd)

Jaroslav Kalista, an employee of the Plzen branch of the State Bank, has reported to the CTK that on 14 August, shortly after 2100 hours, in Strakonice Okres of the South Bohemian kraj, between the villages of Kasejovice and Lnare, he and Jiri Cadek, a resident of Lnare, saw four light discs in the sky. The four discs were all the same distance from one another and formed a slang line above the earth. It appeared that they were standing in one place. According to his report, several more discs appeared after about 5 minutes. The discs broke the regular formation and gradually disappeared. Both phenomena lasted only a few seconds.

Dr. Vladimir Guth, director of the Ondrejov observatory and a corresponding member of the Czechoslovak Academy of Sciences, reported in connection with Kalista's observation: "Recent press reports have prepared people to watch the sky more. Naturally we cannot classify every curious sight as extraterrestrial. I do not believe in flying saucers. There could be several explanations of the phenomenon. The destruction artificial satellites and carrier rockets causes similar phenomena. I was witness to the destruction of a Cosmos artificial satellite. It suddenly lit up and exploded into small glowing pieces. We were not the first to witness such a phenomenon. Artificial satellites regularly break up into 5 or 6 pieces.

"From the meteorological circumstances and astronomical data for that day we can conclude that the 'something' observed was a solid body which was 25 kilometers above the earth. If a known artificial satellite was destroyed we will know it later. It is probable, however, that it involved rocket signals customary in military maneuvers. The possibility is not ruled out that secret experiments are being conducted in the atmosphere the organizers of which want to distract attention from themselves by spreading news about flying saucers." (EEDPR, 7 Sep 65)

DETECTION OF SENSITIVITY TO RADIATION

Prague Mlada Fronta of 24 August 1965 carries an article by Dr. Milan Pospisil, Candidate of Sciences, of the Institute of Biophysics of the Czechoslovak Academy of Sciences in Brno. After dealing with contemporary scientific research and results in radiobiology, Pospisil states that his institute has proven that by following the rate of metabolism it is possible to predict sensitivity of individuals to radiation. The reasons for such reactions are unclear, although one might speculate about the higher production of toxic products by individuals with a higher metabolism. Nevertheless, this knowledge has been utilized for a purposeful influencing of the sensitivity of live tissue, he says.

000569

FDD/EE/7 Sep 65

It is known that thyroxin, a hormone of the thyroid gland, increases metabolism and also increases the sensitivity of organisms and tissue toward radiation. On the other hand, his laboratory has proved that resistance to radiation will tend to decrease the activity of the thyroid gland, Pospisil continues. Endeavors to utilize an artificial decrease of metabolism through the extrinsic colling of organism have great prospects, he says.

With regard to further work, Pospisil states that his institute has worked out a test which will make it possible to predict an individual's reaction to radiation on the basis of the indirect indexes of the activity of his suprarenal gland, and thus to identify resistant and sensitive individuals. (EEPR, 7 Sep 65)

NEW PUBLIC OBSERVATORY -- Prague, Zemedelske Noviny, 19 Aug 65, p 4

On 18 August, the cupola of the new public observatory in Jihlava was installed. The observatory is located atop the three-story Hall of Culture of the Revolutionary Trade Union Movement. A helicopter was employed in the installation of the sections of the 5.5-ton cupola. (EEDPR, 7 Sep 65)

TECHNICAL CONFERENCE -- Prague, Stavebnicky Casopis, No 7, [Aug] 65, p 454

The Fourth Seminar on Photoelasticimetry will be held on 17-18 May 1966 at the Gottwaldov work center of the Advanced Technical School in Brno, which is sponsoring the session. The session will deal with instruments and equipment for photoelasticimetry laboratories. Engr Miroslav Perla, Candidate of Sciences, of the Mining Institute of the Czechoslovak Academy of Sciences in Prague, is chairman of the session's preparatory committee. Further information may be obtained from Engr Jan Cernousek of the Advanced Technical School in Brno, Zalesna 3396.

The Third Seminar on Photoelasticimetry was held in Turcianske Teplice on 17-18 May [1965].. (EEDPR, 7 Sep 65)

000.
570

The author then presents some additional details to illustrate her statements and makes the point that young people today "are obviously not studying for the sake of the financial benefits involved. However, a lot more of them will be attending advanced schools once the anticipated financial rewards will be greater. Capitalism does not have a monopoly on people who like money. While I cannot categorically state that each of the 100,000 students enrolled at our schools is thinking of money alone, I do have the statements of the mothers of our two earlier subjects (the student and the construction helper who are of equal age). According to them, the student is at present working off a brigade with the Prague Municipal Transportation system as a streetcar ticket puncher, whereas the construction helper is about to get married and to spend his honeymoon in Yugoslavia." (EEDPR, 15 Sep 65)

MILITARY ACADEMY GRADUATES RECEIVED BY PRESIDENT

According to the 5 September 1965 issue of Rude Pravo, Czechoslovak Defense Minister Armadni General Bohumir LOMSKY delivered a report to President Novotny at Prague Castle where the President received graduates of various military academies. In a short speech LOMSKY emphasized that two-thirds of the soldiers had graduated with honors, that one-half of them are engineers which demonstrates the importance the army is placing on technology, and that currently every fourth regular army officer is a college graduate. In conclusion, LOMSKY thanked the Party and the government for their "universal zeal which is being dedicated to arming and fortifying the combat capability of our country". He assured his listeners that together with the Soviet and other fraternal armies of the joint Warsaw Pact armed forces, the Czechoslovak army is always ready to fulfill its patriotic and international commitment in defending socialism and peace.

On behalf of the officers, Podplukovník Engr K. LIEBL expressed appreciation for Party and government help in expanding the curriculum in military advanced schools. "The new knowledge, intelligence and experiences will be used by the new commanders in fulfilling their daily tasks, in strengthening combat capability of our army."

The graduates came from the A. Zapotocky Military Academy, the Klement Gottwald Military Academy, the J. E. Purkyne Military Medical Research and Postgraduate Institute, the Military Faculty of the Advanced School for Transportation and from foreign advanced schools.

Also attending the ceremony were KSC (Communist Party of Czechoslovakia) Central Committee Presidium members J. Dolansky, A. Dubcek, J. Hendrych, M. Chudik, D. Kolder, B. Lastovicka, J. Lenart and

(cont'd)